

Hosting Service

The first choice you need to make is which hosting service you want to use. There are different types of hosting services and providers.

For hosting services, the traditional approach was using a **rental server**; however, it is getting less popular now. **Cloud services** or **VPS (Virtual Private Server)** have recently become more popular as you don't need to worry about technical infrastructure management.

There are further different types of cloud services. For example, **PaaS (Platform as a Service)** like **Vercel**, **Firebase**, or **PythonAnywhere** provides easy-to-use services. **IaaS (Infrastructure as a Service)** like **AWS**, **Azure**, or **GCP (Google Cloud Platform)** provides more customizable services. Usually, cloud services use a **pay-per-use** billing model.

VPS is a service similar to IaaS, but its billing scheme is usually fixed price.

In this chapter, we'll use **AWS Lightsail**, which is a VPS service provided by AWS. It offers a three-month free trial.

OS

You need an **OS (Operating System)** to run a Django application. **Linux OS** is the most popular OS for web servers. Linux OS has many **distributions**, such as **Ubuntu**, **CentOS**, **Debian**, and **Fedora**. In this chapter, we use **Ubuntu OS (20.04 LTS)**. You need basic knowledge of Linux OS to deploy your Django app on Linux OS. If you want to learn it, please check our **Linux OS Introduction** course.

[Linux OS Introduction](#)